

UNDERSTANDING YOUR FIRST DD214

Each DD214 is specific to that period of Active Duty – do not discard any prior DD214s

1. If your name is not correct there may be an issue with your CAC card. Update at Home Unit.
2. Make sure your branch is correct
3. Make sure your DOD# is correct
4. Serial number (for office use only)
5. A and b Make sure your grade/rank is correct
6. Make sure your DOB is correct
7.
 - a. This date is 8 years minus 1 day from the date you signed your contract.
 - b. This is the MEPS station you signed your contract at/next DD214 it will be home address
 - c. This is your preferred contract, only Home Unit can update.
 - d. Preferred email contact (MIL or personal)
8. a & b – these were the units you were in here at Fort Gordon
9. This is your new Command – information came from MEPS orders. If this is not up to date you need to show new assignment orders in order to update DD214
10. This is the insurance amount you signed up for – can be changed with new SGLI paperwork.
11. This is your new MOS – make sure it is correct and matches with the education in **Block 14**
12. a - this is the date you came on orders (this is probably the date you went to Boot Camp)
b - should be today's date
c - how long you were on active duty this period
d - for new SMs this will be blank, but on your next DD214 the time in Block C will appear in D
e - the period between signing your contract and going to Boot Camp
f - overseas assignment time will appear in this block
g - at sea the time would appear in this block
h - will match with Block C on this DD214, but will be blank on subsequent DD214s
i - the date of your most recent rank (if 4A & B are wrong, this will also be wrong)
Please Note – you can check your total military time by adding blocks C, D & E together.
13. Awards and ribbons will appear in this block and will roll over from one DD214 to the next.
14. Education should match MOS, and will only appear on this DD214.
15. a & b do not apply to enlisted
c – if you signed up for the Student Loan Repayment Program at enlistment please edit to YES
16. This block will **ALWAYS** be zero – you have to sell/take leave prior to end of orders or lose it.
17. This block is always marked “no”
18. This block will be blank on your 1st DD214 only.
19. a – if changed since signing your contract, please update mailing address & notify Home unit
b - if this information changes at any time, update with Home Unit

You will receive DD214 copies 1, 2 & 4 today –

COPY 1- “I Love Me” book – buy 3-ring binder & put copies of EVERYTHING in here

COPY 2- Put inside 201 file & hand carry to Home Unit